Honorary Homes — Program Redesign as Sister Organization to Griefyard Works

Oct 14, 2026 · @Talen

Summary

Honorary Homes becomes Griefyard Works' sister organization, not its subsidiary, and is redesigned around three participant services: paid jobs, apprenticeship, and housing, plus a property management arm that runs the homes it rehabs and manages buildings for other owners. It pilots in Rutland, VT and Lewiston, ME first, then Baltimore from month 9.

- **Structure:** two equal organizations bound by an affiliation and shared-services agreement. Griefyard Works holds the people-side mission and standards; Honorary Homes runs construction, training and housing.
- **Program:** a paid 6-week pre-apprenticeship leads to supervised crew work on a vacant building, which becomes housing participants can rent and later work toward owning.
- **Behavioral health:** every site and lease is trauma-informed and recovery-ready, while licensed partners deliver all clinical care. Employment, education and housing records stay separate.
- **Locations:** the analyst scoring puts Baltimore (4.35), Lewiston (4.20) and Rutland (4.15) above the 4.0 cutoff. Baltimore enters second because it needs a licensed local partner first.
- **Next step:** six decisions in Section 7, starting with choosing the legal structure.

1. The sister relationship

Honorary Homes stops being a subsidiary of Griefyard Works and becomes its equal: Griefyard Works carries the people-side mission, and Honorary Homes carries the place-side work of housing, jobs and apprenticeship. Neither controls the other; they share standards, referrals and back-office services under written agreements.

Assumption to confirm: Griefyard Works' exact current services are not in the brief, so its role below is drawn from how the September 2026 blueprint describes it (mission standards, shared systems, survivor-informed accountability).

Structure options (counsel decides)

Option	How it works	Best when	Watch for
A. Common holding entity	A small holding company or family-of-companies owns both; each has its own board and officers	Both are for-profit or both nonprofit	Holding entity becomes the true parent in filings and schema
B. Affiliated by agreement	Separate legal entities, overlapping founder, bound by an affiliation and shared-services agreement	Fastest to stand up; keeps each brand independent	Arm's-length pricing for shared staff and services
C. Nonprofit + enterprise pair	Griefyard Works stays mission/charitable side; Honorary Homes is the revenue enterprise	Grants flow to one, contracts and property revenue to the other	Private-benefit and conflict-of-interest rules if Griefyard is a 501(c)(3); board independence

Recommendation: start with **Option B** for the 18-month pilot, written so it can convert to A or C once revenue, insurance and funding sources are known.

Who owns what

Area	Griefyard Works (sister)	Honorary Homes (sister)	Shared under agreement
Mission standards	Survivor-informed and grief-informed practice standards	Applies them to sites, crews, housing	Annual joint standards review
People support	Wellbeing partnerships, peer and advocacy referrals	Supervisor training, workplace accommodations	Warm-handoff referral protocol
Housing	None directly	Keyline, First Key, Quiet Key operations	Quiet Key partner MOUs

Area	Griefyard Works (sister)	Honorary Homes (sister)	Shared under agreement
Jobs and apprenticeship	Pre-employment readiness referrals	Employer of record, Earned Ground, Field School	Participant data-sharing consent forms
Construction and property	None	Honorary Build, Vacant Bone	None
Back office	Optional host of finance, HR, compliance staff	Pays its share	Shared-services fee schedule

What changes in the website build spec

- Endorsement line `A GRIEFYARD WORKS COMPANY` becomes `SISTER TO GRIEFYARD WORKS`.
- Footer text becomes: **Honorary Homes and Griefyard Works are sister organizations.** Visit griefyardworks.org →
- Remove `parentOrganization` from Organization JSON-LD. Schema.org has no sibling property; if a holding entity exists (Option A), both organizations list it as `parentOrganization`. Otherwise state the relationship in `description` only.
- `/about/griefyard-works` copy: "Two organizations, one standard. Griefyard Works holds the people-side mission; Honorary Homes builds the places, jobs and pathways."
- Rename analytics event `griefyard_parent_link_clicked` to `griefyard_sister_link_clicked`.
- Strike "parent strategy" and "built-environment company of Griefyard Works" everywhere; keep the link to https://griefyardworks.org on every page.
- Add **Property Management** to primary navigation and a `/property-management` route for owners, with an owner inquiry form (property type, units, location, current management, services wanted) routed to a new `PROPERTY_MANAGEMENT_DESTINATION`.
- Add a private `ManagedProperties` CMS collection (owner, units, service tier, contract dates, address visibility); never publish managed addresses.
- Add a seventh audience door on the homepage: "I own a building that needs managing."
- Add analytics events `pm_inquiry_started` and `pm_inquiry_submitted` with no owner or address data.

2. Program design (Program Development Manager)

The redesigned program has three service lines (Housing, Jobs, Apprenticeship) fed by two engines (Honorary Build and Vacant Bone) and held together by one participant route, the Honorary Loop. The pilot proves the loop at one site per state before anything scales.

Problem statement

Three shortages sit in the same towns: too few usable homes, too many idle buildings, and too few people entering the building trades. People leaving instability, recovery or violence face all three at once, and most programs address only one.

Theory of change

If Honorary Homes uses paid rehab of idle buildings as the classroom, then participants earn wages and skills while the buildings become housing they can rent and later buy. Behavioral health supports delivered by partners keep people in the work long enough for that to happen.

Redesigned service lines

Service line	What participants get	Delivered by	Entry point
Jobs (Honorary Build crews)	Paid W-2 work on residential and light commercial jobs, crew-leader supervision	Honorary Homes as employer	Interest form, partner referral
Apprenticeship (Field School + Earned Ground)	4–8 week paid pre-apprenticeship, then placement in a registered apprenticeship with Honorary Homes or a partner employer	Field School; state-registered sponsor	Cohort application

Service line	What participants get	Delivered by	Entry point
Housing (Keyline, First Key, Quiet Key)	Transitional or rental units in rehabbed buildings; ownership prep after 24+ months; confidential survivor track	Honorary Homes as landlord; housing and survivor-service partners	Separate housing application
Property management (Honorary Property Services)	Maintenance-technician career track; well-run homes for tenants	Honorary Homes as manager of its own and others' buildings	Cohort track for workers; owner inquiry for clients
Engines (Build revenue, Vacant Bone)	Real job sites and the housing stock itself	Honorary Homes	Not a participant entry

Pilot cohort model (per site, year one)

1. **Recruit and screen for fit, not deficit** — 12–15 participants per cohort, two cohorts a year. No questions about trauma or diagnosis at intake.
2. **Pre-apprenticeship, 6 weeks, paid** — OSHA 10, tool and measurement basics, jobsite conduct, financial coaching.
3. **Supervised crew placement** — on one Vacant Bone building (target 2–6 units) plus client jobs. Ratio no worse than 1 crew lead to 4 trainees.
4. **Housing offer** — eligible participants may apply for a unit; the lease is independent of the job.
5. **Advance or transfer** — into registered apprenticeship, a partner employer, or continued Honorary crew work.
6. **Return** — graduates are offered paid peer-mentor or crew-lead roles for later cohorts.

Logic model

Inputs	Activities	Outputs (year one, per site)	Short-term outcomes	Long-term outcomes
Program staff, crew leads, property manager, one building, partner MOUs, start-up capital	Paid pre-apprenticeship, crew work, housing placement, property management, partner-delivered support	2 cohorts; 24–30 enrolled; 1 building in rehab; 2–6 units online and under management	70%+ complete pre-apprenticeship; 60%+ in paid trade work at 90 days; units occupied and maintained	Wage growth, housing stability at 12 months, ownership readiness, management revenue, graduates mentoring

Targets above are planning assumptions to be set against a baseline, not claims.

Property management (Honorary Property Services)

Property management becomes the fourth service line: it runs every unit Honorary Homes rehabs, sells management to other owners, and gives crews steady year-round maintenance work to learn on.

Why it fits the loop

- **Keeps rehabbed homes good.** Units brought back by Vacant Bone are maintained by the same standard, not handed off and left to decline.
- **Recurring revenue.** Management fees and maintenance billing smooth out the seasonal ups and downs of construction.
- **A training ground in winter.** Turnovers, repairs and preventive maintenance keep apprentices working when exterior work slows.
- **A new trade track.** Maintenance technician becomes a career path alongside carpentry.
- **A property pipeline.** Small landlords who can no longer manage aging buildings become referrals for sale to Vacant Bone.

Two tiers

Tier	Whose buildings	Services	Start
Own portfolio	Keyline, First Key and Quiet Key units Honorary Homes owns or controls	Leasing, rent collection, maintenance, turnovers, inspections, capital planning	Month 9, as first units lease
Third-party	Small landlords, housing authorities, nonprofits, municipalities, land banks	Full or maintenance-only management; turnover and rehab-to-rent packages	Month 12, after licensing is confirmed

Services offered

- Leasing and tenant screening under a written, fair-housing-reviewed policy
- Rent collection and owner reporting
- Work orders, preventive maintenance and turnovers, done by supervised crews
- Inspection readiness for voucher programs and lead-safe compliance
- Capital planning: what to fix this year, what can wait
- Resident services coordination: trauma-informed front desk and referral to partners, never clinical

Safeguards when tenants are also workers

- A participant's crew lead never manages or enters that participant's home except for a scheduled, noticed repair with another staff member present.
- Lease decisions follow written policy, with an independent review before any eviction filing.
- Property staff have no access to employment or training files, and the reverse.
- Quiet Key addresses and records are restricted to the property manager and the survivor-service partner.

Licensing to verify: managing buildings for other owners commonly requires a real estate or property management license in each state; managing your own buildings usually does not. Confirm Vermont, Maine and Maryland rules before signing any third-party contract.

Measures: occupancy, days to turn a unit, work-order response time, rent collected as a share of rent due, tenant satisfaction, and eviction filings.

Added roles: Property Manager (licensed where required) at month 9; Maintenance Lead at month 12; maintenance apprentices drawn from each cohort.

3. Behavioral health design (Behavioral Health Lead)

Honorary Homes is a workplace and a landlord, not a clinic: it designs every site, crew and lease to be trauma-informed and recovery-ready, and it routes all clinical care to licensed partners. This keeps participants' health information out of their employment file and keeps the company from acting as boss, landlord and therapist to the same person.

The clinical boundary

Honorary Homes does	Partners do (by MOU)	Never
Trauma-informed supervision, predictable schedules, clear rules	Counseling, substance use treatment, psychiatric care	Therapy delivered by a supervisor or landlord
Peer mentors and a wellbeing lead who make warm handoffs	Survivor advocacy, safety planning, legal advocacy (Quiet Key)	Treatment as a condition of housing
Reasonable accommodations, leave, return-to-work plans	Crisis response (988, mobile crisis)	Health details in personnel or tenancy files
Recovery-friendly workplace policies	Medication for opioid use disorder prescribing	Firing or eviction as the response to a relapse alone

Six design standards

1. **Safety first, without surveillance.** Fit-for-duty and drug policies follow safety-sensitive rules and disability law, applied the same way to every worker.
2. **Predictability.** Schedules posted two weeks ahead; no surprise changes to pay, housing or crew.
3. **Choice.** Participants choose whether to use any support service and which partner provides it.
4. **Separation.** Three walls: employment, education, housing. Consent forms say exactly what moves between them.

5. **Second attempts are built in.** A relapse or crisis triggers a return-to-work plan, not automatic exit. Housing tenancy stands on its own lease terms.
6. **Staff are protected too.** Crew leads get supervision, debriefs after hard incidents, and their own access to support.

Behavioral health roles

Role	Licensed?	Does	Does not
Behavioral Health & Wellbeing Lead (1 FTE, shared across sites)	Yes (LICSW, LCPC, LCSW-C by state) but works in a non-treating role	Writes protocols, trains supervisors, manages partner MOUs, reviews incidents	Carry a caseload of employees or tenants
Peer Support Specialist (1 per site)	State peer certification	Weekly check-ins, warm handoffs, cohort groups on stress and money	Clinical assessment
Crew Lead (trained)	Trade credentials	Trauma-informed supervision, Mental Health First Aid, early notice	Ask about diagnosis or history
Partner clinicians	Yes	All treatment	—

Training every supervisor completes before a cohort starts

- Mental Health First Aid (or equivalent)
- Trauma-informed supervision, half day
- Suicide prevention for construction (QPR or equivalent)
- Naloxone use; naloxone stocked on every site and in every building
- De-escalation and when to call 988 or 911
- Confidentiality: what a supervisor may and may not record

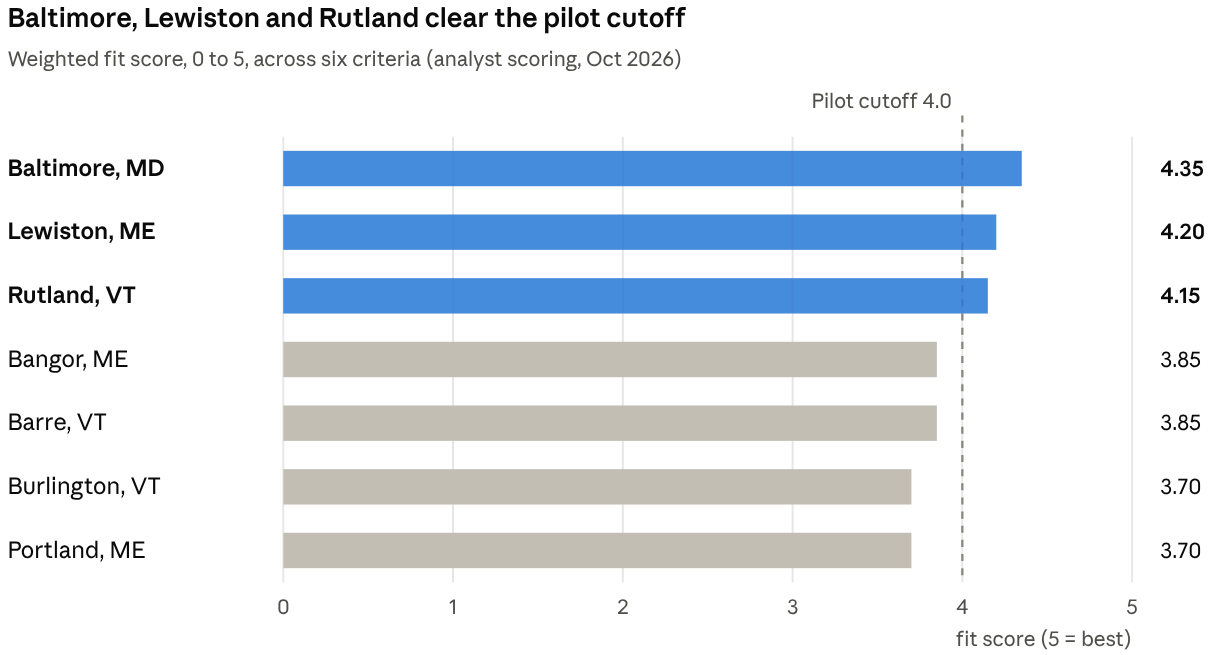
Housing safeguards

- Housing First principles on Keyline units: no sobriety or treatment requirement to hold a lease.

- Optional recovery-focused units only through a certified recovery-residence partner.
- Quiet Key addresses known only to the survivor-service partner and the property manager.
- A grievance route that sits outside the participant's crew chain.

4. Location study (with the analyst)

Start in **Rutland, VT** and **Lewiston, ME**, then add **Baltimore** in month 9 through a partner in a state-funded reinvestment area. All three combine old, cheap, rehab-ready buildings with a trades shortage, which is exactly the mix the Honorary Loop needs.



Analyst scoring of 7 candidate locations · component scores in the table below · sources listed at end

Baltimore scores highest on paper but needs a licensed local partner and contractor licensing first, so it enters second.

How locations were scored

Criterion	Weight	What a 5 means
Housing need	25%	Documented shortage and very low vacancy for year-round homes

Criterion	Weight	What a 5 means
Distressed stock to rehab	20%	Many old or vacant buildings, attainable to acquire
Trades workforce gap	15%	Documented shortage of carpenters and other trades
Behavioral health partner depth	15%	Several licensed providers, crisis services, survivor-service agencies
Funding and policy tailwinds	15%	Active public money for rehab, apprenticeship or recovery
Cost of entry	10%	Low acquisition and rehab cost per unit

Scores are analyst judgment (1–5) drawn from the indicators below, not a statistical model. Refresh them with county-level data before any acquisition.

Component scores and evidence

Location	Need	Stock	Workforce	BH	Funding	Cost	Key evidence
Baltimore, MD	4	5	3	5	5	4	11,839 buildings under vacant notices (April 2026); about 3,400 uninhabitable 20+ years; $100M state reinvestment across 16 communities, about 1,700 properties; receivership auctions require rehab within a year
Lewiston, ME	4	5	4	4	4	4	Some of Maine's oldest stock, most multi-unit buildings pre-1940; vacant uninhabitable buildings a long-standing problem; 1,325 units in the pipeline creates construction demand; state rehab tax credit in use
Rutland, VT	4	5	4	3	4	5	About half of homes built before 1939; county needs 2,531–3,618 homes 2025–2029; flood-recovery funds earmarked for Rutland County
Bangor, ME	4	4	4	4	3	4	700-unit shortage for households under $35,000; city holds vacant, placarded properties it can rehab or redevelop

Location	Need	Stock	Workforce	BH	Funding	Cost	Key evidence
Barre, VT	4	4	4	3	4	4	2023 floods damaged 200+ homes; ~$68M federal recovery funds statewide with ~200 units planned; floodplain limits where to build
Burlington, VT	5	2	4	5	4	1	Chittenden County needs 7,982–11,063 homes, but acquisition costs are the state's highest
Portland, ME	5	2	4	5	4	1	Largest share of Maine's need sits in the southern coast; costs rule out a first pilot

Statewide context: Vermont needs about 36,000 year-round homes from 2025–2029 with rental vacancy near 3%; Maine needs 76,400–84,300 new units by 2030. Vermont expects to need about 5,000 new carpenters over ten years; Maine has the oldest construction workforce in the country (median age 47).

Recommended sites

Phase	Site	Why	First building target	Partners to approach
1 (months 1–9)	Rutland, VT	Cheapest old stock in the HQ state; flood-recovery money; closest to operations	2–4 unit pre-1940 house, outside floodplain	Rutland County designated mental health agency, career center, regional housing nonprofit
1 (months 1–9)	Lewiston, ME	Mill-city multi-family stock built for rehab-to-own; strong local construction demand	Triple-decker or 4-unit building	Lewiston Housing, community college pre-apprenticeship, local behavioral health agency

Phase	Site	Why	First building target	Partners to approach
2 (months 9–18)	Baltimore, MD	Largest vacant pipeline and public money; rowhouse rehab suits small crews	1–2 rowhouses via receivership auction or a community developer	A community developer in a Reinvest Baltimore area, Behavioral Health System Baltimore network providers
Watch	Bangor, ME; Barre, VT	Strong need; enter after first pilots prove the model	—	—

5. Staffing and funding

The two phase-one sites need about 9 FTE of program and behavioral health staff, plus crew leads and a small property management team, funded by a mix of earned revenue, workforce dollars and housing capital. Dollar amounts are not set here; build the budget once the first two buildings are identified.

Staffing plan

Role	Phase 1 (2 sites)	Phase 2 (+ Baltimore)	Reports to
Program Development Manager	1	1	Executive Director
Behavioral Health & Wellbeing Lead	1	1	Executive Director (not the crew chain)
Site Program Coordinator	2	3	Program Development Manager
Peer Support Specialist	2	3	Wellbeing Lead
Crew Lead (licensed where required)	2–4	3–6	Construction Operations

Role	Phase 1 (2 sites)	Phase 2 (+ Baltimore)	Reports to
Field School Instructor (part-time)	1	2	Program Development Manager
Property Manager (licensed where required)	1 (from month 9)	2	Executive Director (separate from crew chain)
Maintenance Lead	1 (from month 12)	2	Property Manager
Maintenance technician apprentices	2	4	Maintenance Lead
Data & Evaluation Analyst	0.5	1	Program Development Manager

Revenue and funding streams (kept separate in the books)

Stream	Pays for	Examples to pursue
Construction revenue	Crew wages, overhead	Residential and light commercial client work in each region
Property management fees	Property staff, maintenance crews	Fee as a share of rent collected, plus billed maintenance and turnover work for outside owners
Workforce and apprenticeship funds	Pre-apprenticeship wages, instruction, supportive services	WIOA through local workforce boards; Maine reimburses part of classroom costs for registered and pre-apprenticeship programs
Housing capital	Acquisition and rehab	CDBG and flood-recovery CDBG-DR (Vermont), Maine rehabilitation tax credit, Reinvest Baltimore (Maryland DHCD)

Stream	Pays for	Examples to pursue
Rents	Operating the units	Market and voucher-supported rents
Philanthropy (through an eligible entity)	Behavioral health supports, evaluation, start-up	Community foundations, health-system community benefit, workforce funders
Course sales	Field School operations	Paid courses and employer contracts

If Griefyard Works is a nonprofit, grants for behavioral health supports can flow to it and be delivered to Honorary Homes participants under the shared-services agreement.

6. Measures, governance and risk

Track nine measures from day one, report them quarterly to both sister boards, and publish only what has been verified.

Core measures

Measure	Definition	Collected by
Completion	Share of enrollees finishing pre-apprenticeship	Site Coordinator
Paid placement	Share in paid trade work at 90 and 180 days	Data Analyst
Wage growth	Change in hourly wage from entry to 12 months	Data Analyst
Credential progress	Registered apprenticeship entry; OSHA and trade credentials earned	Field School
Housing stability	Tenants housed at 12 months; evictions	Property Manager
Units returned to use	Vacant units brought to occupancy	Construction Operations
Property performance	Occupancy, days to turn a unit, work-order response time, rent collected vs due	Property Manager

Measure	Definition	Collected by
Wellbeing access	Share who used any partner support (count only, no clinical detail)	Wellbeing Lead
Safety	Recordable injuries; critical incidents and response time	Construction Operations

Governance

- Joint Standards Committee (two members from each sister board) meets quarterly and reviews the measures, incidents and grievances.
- Program Development Manager owns the logic model, budget-to-actual and partner MOUs.
- Wellbeing Lead holds an independent line to the Executive Director so safety concerns never stop at a crew lead.
- Every public claim follows the website's claim-control rules: verified, pending or not shown.

Top risks

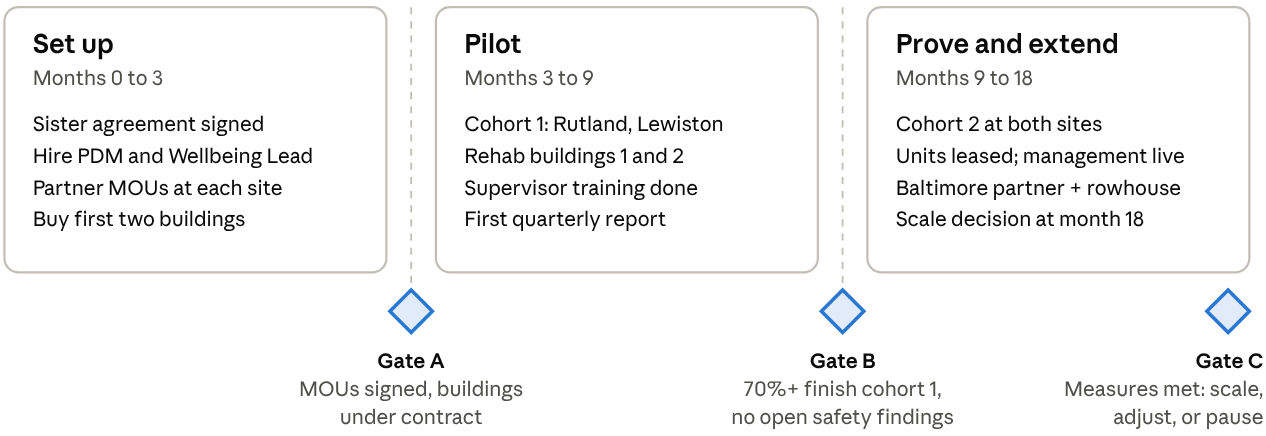
Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Worker suicide and overdose risk; construction and extraction had the highest male suicide rate in CDC's occupational study (53.2 per 100,000 in 2015)	High	Suicide-prevention training, naloxone on site, peer check-ins, 988 protocol
Dual roles (boss and landlord) create coercion	Medium	Separate leases, separate grievance route, no housing loss tied to job loss alone
Property management blurs landlord and employer roles	Medium	Separate staff and files; crew lead never manages a participant's home; independent review before any eviction filing
Third-party management without the required license	Medium	Confirm licensing in each state before any outside contract; manage own units only until then

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Rehab cost overruns on old buildings (lead, asbestos, structure)	High	Pre-purchase inspection, contingency of at least 15%, start with small buildings
Partner MOUs slip and services lag the cohort	Medium	Sign MOUs before recruiting; backup provider per site
Baltimore licensing and speculator competition	Medium	Enter through a community developer and receivership pipeline; secure Maryland home-improvement licensing first
Sister-entity conflicts of interest	Medium	Arm's-length shared-services pricing, recusal rules, counsel review

7. 18-month roadmap and decisions needed

The program moves through three phases, and nothing advances past a gate until its criteria are met.

Three gates decide whether the pilot scales by month 18



18-month roadmap · 3 phases, 3 gates

Gate B's 70% completion figure is a planning target to confirm against comparable pre-apprenticeship programs.

Decisions needed now

- [ ] Choose the sister structure (Option A, B or C) with counsel
- [ ] Confirm what Griefyard Works delivers today, so the shared-services agreement matches reality
- [ ] Approve Rutland and Lewiston as phase-one sites, or name alternates
- [ ] Approve hiring the Program Development Manager and Behavioral Health & Wellbeing Lead first
- [ ] Pick the registered-apprenticeship route in each state: own sponsorship or a partner sponsor
- [ ] Confirm property management licensing rules in Vermont, Maine and Maryland
- [ ] Decide whether third-party management starts at month 12 or waits for phase 2
- [ ] Approve the website brand and navigation changes in Section 1

Sources

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- Testimony on construction workforce and apprenticeship — Maine Legislature
- Lewiston Consolidated Plan, housing conditions — HUD archive (older plan; conditions to re-verify)
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- Bangor housing shortage of 700 affordable units — Bangor Daily News, Jan 2026
- How Bangor will prioritize housing — Bangor Daily News
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- Baltimore's longest-vacant houses — Baltimore Banner
- Construction workers have highest rate of suicide — Construction Dive, on CDC MMWR